

Lawal Hussein Taiwo

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Portfolio: <https://full-stack-developer-lemon.vercel.app/>

Profile

Python/Django Developer with 3+ years of experience building and deploying high-performance web applications in fintech, SaaS, and logistics. Skilled in designing scalable RESTful APIs, optimizing relational databases, and applying security best practices for production-ready systems. Proficient in authentication and authorization (JWT, OAuth2/OIDC), integrating AI/ML features and third-party services (payment gateways, messaging APIs, analytics), containerizing applications with Docker, and deploying on AWS, Render, and Heroku. Strong background in Agile development, TDD, and CI/CD, with a proven ability to deliver end-to-end solutions — from system architecture and database design to frontend integration, cloud deployment, and model inference pipelines.

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages:** Python, JavaScript, Java
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** Django, Django REST Framework (DRF), Flask, FastAPI, React.js, Node.js
- **Frontend & UI:** HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Chart.js
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, SQLite, Supabase, Appwrite
- **Authentication & Authorization:** JWT, OAuth2/OIDC, Session-based Authentication
- **Cloud & DevOps Tools:** Docker, AWS, Heroku, Render, Git, Redis, Celery, Cloudinary, Zapier
- **Web Scraping & Automation:** Selenium, BeautifulSoup, Requests
- **Development Practices:** Test-Driven Development (TDD), CI/CD, REST API Design, Authentication & Security .

Professional Experience

Software Engineer – Altivox (Freelancer)

- Built and deployed a Logistics & Delivery Tracking System using Django, PostgreSQL, Tailwind, and Chart.js.
- Implemented session-based authentication for secure user and admin access.
- Developed an interactive KPI dashboard with Chart.js, enabling real-time performance insights.
- Designed advanced reporting and filtering features for shipment analysis and operational efficiency.
- Integrated async background tasks for email notifications and system alerts.
- Optimized database queries, boosting application performance by 35%.
- Enhanced delivery workflows, improving on-time delivery rates by 25% through live status tracking.

Python Developer – Bincom Dev Center, Lagos (Apprentice)

- Designed and implemented Django-based applications with secure authentication and REST APIs.
- Applied data science libraries (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn) to prototype analytics and predictive features.

Python Developer Intern – Prodigy InfoTech, Mumbai

- Developed Python-based GUI applications, including a Temperature Converter and Contact Management System.
- Improved application usability and optimized performance for end-users.

Student Software Engineer – Power Learn Project (Africa Cohort 4)

- Selected as part of the 2024 PLP Africa Cohort 4, a competitive training program for emerging software engineers.
- Expanded expertise across web development (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) and mobile app development with Dart and Flutter.
- Strengthened backend development skills through hands-on projects using Django and Python programming.
- Collaborated with peers in an Agile learning environment to deliver functional, real-world applications.

Projects

E-commerce Web Application

- Built a full-stack e-commerce platform enabling users to browse, add to cart, and securely checkout using integrated payment gateways (Paystack/Stripe).
- Implemented email-based authentication, password reset, and role-based access control (admin/customers).
- Designed normalized PostgreSQL schema, achieving 30% faster query response times through indexing and optimization.
- Integrated Celery with Redis for order notifications and automated email receipts.
- Deployed to Render with environment-specific configurations and managed product images via Cloudinary.

Referral Email Automation Platform

- Re-engineered the legacy email notification system by replacing direct API calls with a Zapier-based automation workflow, ensuring compliance with company-wide technical policies.
- Implemented a Django API (`start\_workflow`) that receives JSON payloads, validates input, and securely forwards data to Zapier webhooks.
- Added environment-aware logic (staging vs production) to handle safe testing and production-grade reliability.
- Designed exception handling with custom logging to improve system resilience and error tracking.
- Built a React.js frontend (app router) with a form-based UI, allowing users to trigger referral workflows seamlessly.
- Result: Centralized all third-party email operations under a maintainable, automated pipeline, reducing integration overhead and improving scalability.

Logistics Management System

- Developed a logistics and shipment management application for tracking orders, drivers, and delivery routes.
- Integrated Google Maps APIs for live location tracking and optimized route assignments.
- Designed an admin dashboard for operational efficiency and automated email alerts for shipment updates.
- Result: streamlined order tracking and improved customer communication across devices.

Chat Application

- Real-time chat application built with Django with features for user authentication, friend lists, profile management, messaging (text & voice notes), and unread message indicators.
- Designed UI with Tailwind CSS and Django templates; ensured mobile-responsive layout, with clean navigation and profile settings.
- Used Django `Q` objects for querying bidirectional conversations and implemented message ordering and unread count logic.
- Included file uploads for voice notes, managing media uploads and serving via Django's media settings.
- Employed SQLite (or other Django-supported DB) for development with planned migrations to PostgreSQL / MySQL for production scaling.
- Optimized static/media file handling, profiles and image uploads for performance and user experience.

Trip Booking Management System

- Built a travel organization platform ("Expense Voyage") with account management, trip scheduling, pricing, and ticket notifications.
- Integrated review system, direct support contact, and an admin approval workflow.
- Implemented notification emails for trip updates and bookings, including digital flight tickets.

Affiliate Platform

- Built a web-based affiliate platform using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Supabase, and Paystack.
- Implemented user registration and authentication with Supabase.
- Developed affiliate referral tracking and automated updates to sales dashboards.
- Integrated Paystack API for secure payment processing.
- Designed as a frontend-only solution with no dedicated backend server.

Email Automation Tool

- Built a scalable email system capable of sending thousands of emails with attachments securely via SMTP.
- Reduced manual email workflows by 80%, enabling faster communication for small businesses.
- Added user-friendly bulk upload interface for multiple recipients with validation checks.

Education

Aptech, Lagos – Advanced Diploma in Software Engineering (2023 – 2025)

NIIT, Lagos – Python Programming Certificate (2022 – 2023)